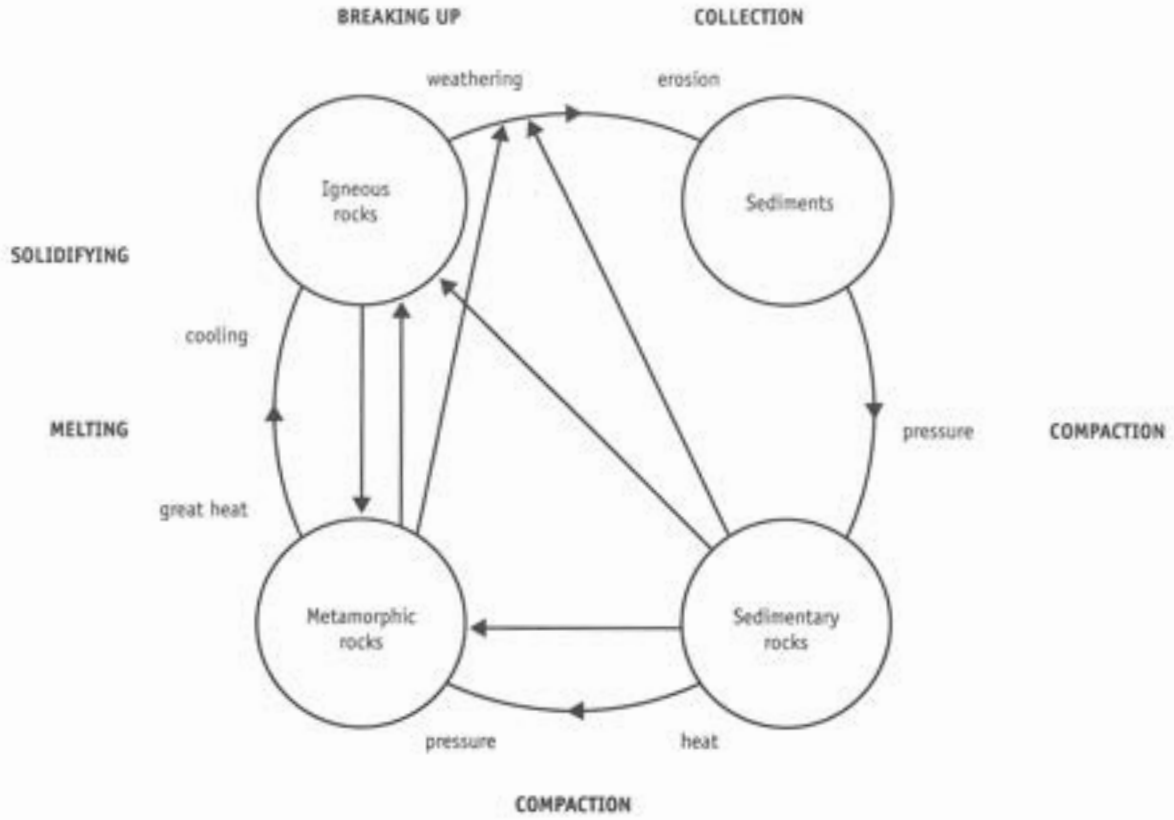
The rock cycle

4a



1 Look at the diagram of the rock cycle. Some terms are in circles, some are in capital letters and the others are in lower case. Suggest what each type of term represents.

a Terms in circles: _____

b Terms in capitals: _____

c Terms in lower case: _____

2 Look at the diagram. Define the following processes and explain how they occur.

a Breaking up: _____

b Collection: _____

c Compaction: _____

d Melting: _____

e Solidifying: _____

3 Look at the diagram and state which materials could become the following rock types.

a Igneous rocks: _____

b Metamorphic rocks: _____

c Sedimentary rocks: _____

d Sediments: _____

© Chris Greef, Suada Bilali and Learning Essentials, 2003.

The rock cycle

4b

Looking at language

Complex sentences are made up of two clauses: an *independent clause*, which could be a sentence by itself, and a *dependent clause*, which usually begins with a conjunction (joining word) and needs an independent clause in order to make sense.

4 Refer to the previous diagram and the tables below and write six sentences about the rock cycle. For each independent clause you need to select a subject, a verb and an adverbial phrase; for each dependent clause you need to choose a conjunction, a subject, a verb and an adverbial phrase. You may choose some terms more than once. The first sentence has been done for you.

Dependent clauses

Conjunction	Subject	Verb	Adverbial phrase
as	liquid rock	*are*	to great heat
because	*sediments*	are eroded	to heat and pressure
since	sediments	are exposed	*under pressure*
when	sedimentary and metamorphic rocks	are weathered	—
	sedimentary, metamorphic and igneous rocks	is cooled	
	sedimentary rocks		

Independent clauses

Subject	Verb	Adverbial phrase
it	are changed	as layers of sediments
the rock material	*are compacted*	into igneous rocks
they	break up	into liquid rock
	collect	into metamorphic rocks
	melts	*into sedimentary rocks*
	solidifies	into sediments

a *When sediments are under pressure, they are compacted into sedimentary rocks.*

b _____

_____

c _____

_____

d _____

_____

e _____

_____

f _____

_____

© Chris Greef, Suada Bilali and Learning Essentials, 2003.